

IT Troubleshooting

Objective

Practice technical communication in realistic IT support situations between a technician and a client.

Procedure & Rules

- Work in pairs: **client** (user) and **technician** (IT support).
 - The technician must:
 - ask at least **three diagnostic questions**;
 - listen carefully and identify possible causes;
 - suggest clear, polite solutions in English;
 - **never ask for the user's password**.
 - The client must:
 - describe the problem and its symptoms;
 - answer the technician's questions clearly;
 - mention any error messages and recent changes.
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Scenario 1 – Wi-Fi Not Visible

Situation: “I can't connect to the office Wi-Fi. The network name doesn't appear on my laptop.”

Possible causes:

- Access point is down or misconfigured.
- SSID is hidden.
- Wi-Fi adapter or driver problem on the laptop.

First checks:

- Is Wi-Fi turned on?
 - Can you see other Wi-Fi networks?
 - Can other users see the office network?
 - Restart the laptop and try again.
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Scenario 2 – Printer Not Working

Situation: “I sent a document to print, but nothing happens.”

The screen shows: “**Paper jam.**”

Possible causes:

- Paper jam
- Empty paper tray
- Printer is offline or has a connection problem.
- Driver or print queue issue.

Troubleshooting steps:

- Check for and carefully remove any jammed paper.
- Check and refill the paper tray if necessary.
- Check the printer status: online or offline.
- Verify the network or USB connection.
- Restart the printer.

- If necessary, check the print queue or printer driver.
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Scenario 3 – Login / Password Problem

Situation: “I can’t log in. It says ‘Access denied’.”

Possible reasons:

- Incorrect username or password.
- Caps Lock is enabled.
- Wrong keyboard layout.
- Password has expired.
- Account is locked after several failed attempts.

Reset procedure (example):

1. Click “**Forgot password?**”
2. Enter your **username** or **email address**.
3. Follow the password-reset instructions.
4. Create a new password according to the company’s password policy.

Security rule: Technicians must never ask users to reveal their password.

Scenario 4 – 404 Error

Situation: “I get a **404 Not Found** error when I try to access an internal web page.”

What does a 404 error mean?

A **404 Not Found** error usually means that the web server cannot find the requested page at the specified URL.

Possible causes:

- The URL is incorrect or contains a typing error.
- The page has been moved to a different URL.
- The page has been deleted.
- A link on the website is broken or outdated.
- The web server has an incorrect configuration or redirect.

Diagnostic questions:

- “What is the exact URL you are trying to access?”
- “Does the 404 error happen every time?”
- “Can other users access the same page?”
- “Can you access other pages on the internal website?”
- “Did the problem start recently?”

Possible solutions:

- Check and correct the URL.
- Try accessing the page from the website’s homepage.
- Check whether the page has been moved.
- Fix or update the broken link.
- Restore the page if it was deleted by mistake.
- Check the web server configuration and redirects if necessary.

Important: A 404 error does **not necessarily mean that the server is down**. The server may be working correctly while the requested page is missing.

Scenario 5 – Phishing Attempt

Situation: “I clicked on a suspicious link in an email and downloaded a suspicious file.”

Warning signs of a phishing email:

- Urgent or threatening language, such as “Update your password now” or “Your account will be closed.”
- An unexpected or suspicious link.
- An unknown or unexpected sender.
- A strange or misleading email address.
- A generic greeting instead of the user’s name.
- A request for passwords, personal information, or payment details.
- Suspicious attachments, especially files with double extensions such as `.pdf.exe`.

Diagnostic questions:

- “Did you open or run the downloaded file?”
- “Did you enter your password or any personal information?”
- “Did you click on any other links?”
- “When did this happen?”
- “Have you noticed anything unusual on your computer since then?”

Immediate actions:

1. **Do not open the suspicious file or click any more links.**
2. If the file was opened or malware is suspected, **disconnect the computer from the network** (Wi-Fi and/or Ethernet) if this is consistent with the company’s incident-response procedure.
3. **Contact IT/security support immediately** and report what happened.
4. Provide useful details, such as the sender, subject, link, file name, and approximate time of the incident.
5. Follow the company’s **incident-response procedure**.
6. IT/security staff may need to scan the computer, isolate it, or take other containment measures.
7. If credentials may have been compromised, **change the password from a known-clean device**, following company policy.

Important: Do not assume that simply deleting the downloaded file solves the problem. If the file was opened or executed, the incident should be reported to IT/security.

Useful Questions for the Technician

- “When did the problem start?”
 - “What exactly happens?”
 - “Do you get an error message? What does it say?”
 - “Did anything change recently?”
 - “Does this happen every time?”
 - “Is anyone else affected?”
 - “What have you already tried?”
 - “Did you open or click anything unusual?”
 - “Can you reproduce the problem?”
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Useful Expressions

- “Let’s check a few things.”
 - “Could you restart the computer?”
 - “Could you tell me exactly what happens?”
 - “The problem may be related to...”
 - “Please try again and tell me what happens.”
 - “Let’s see if the problem occurs on another computer.”
 - “I recommend that you contact IT support.”
 - “Please do not click on the link again.”
 - “If the problem persists, let us know.”
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Diagnostic Method - 5 Steps

1. **Identify symptoms:** “What exactly is happening?”
2. **Gather information:** “When did it start? Did anything change recently??”
3. **Test simple causes:** Power, cables, connections, restarts.
4. **Test a solution:** Apply an appropriate fix, such as changing a setting, restarting a service, or reinstalling a driver.
5. **Verify the solution:** “Could you try again? Is the problem fixed?”

Key principle: Ask → Check → Test → Fix → Verify. Do not jump directly to a solution.
